AWARDS

CELEBRATING THE *SHE POWER*

Harper's Bazaar Women of the Year awards fete 18 trailblazers and their accomplishments

"Girl power at its sparkly best" is how Kalli Purie, Vice Chairperson & Executive Editor-in-Chief, India Today Group, described attending a Taylor Swift concert with her teenage daughter in Wembley. It's an ideal descriptor for the Indian edition of the Harper's Bazaar Women of the Year awards too, a night high on fashion, sisterhood, gratitude and joy as women celebrated each other's achievements.

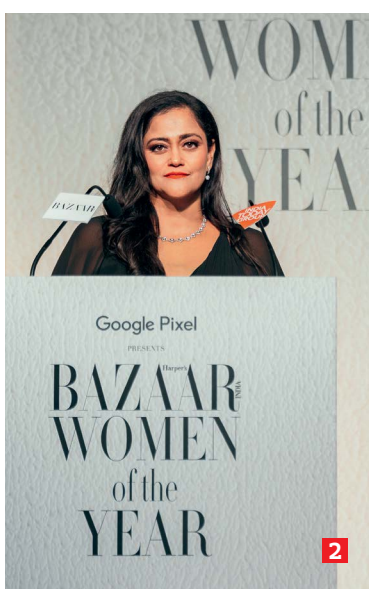
The "human chain of inspiration", which saw one award recipient presenting to another achiever, resulted in some memorable moments on stage. The iconic fashion designer Anita Dongre felt honoured to receive the award from two-time Paralympic shooting champion Avani Lekhara, who in turn had won in the Sportsperson category. Isha Ambani was bestowed the Icon of the Year award by the Interior Designer winner Gauri Khan, while the Spotlight Actor, Ananya Panday, handed the Style Icon trophy to Natasha Poonawalla. Payal Kapadia won the Film Director prize after making history as the first Indian filmmaker to win the prestigious Cannes Grand Prix award for her debut feature, *All We Imagine as Light*. The *Archies* star Dot. rounded off the evening with a rendition of her lovely songs.

As India became the fifth country to host these awards, Kalli Purie noted that Bazaar as a brand has been a champion for women for the last 157 years. Highlighting that the 18 awardees' accomplishments stood out regardless of their gender, she added, "We are not typecasting or restricting them to women-only category because they are extraordinary individuals who would be recognised in any environment." If anything, Kapadia, Lekhara, Booker Prize-winning author Geetanjali Shree and others possess the talent that make them role models for everyone, across age and gender. ■

–Suhani Singh



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